

External storage devices

Data is the backbone of technology, and over the years, the storage space that the average tech savvy person needs has skyrocketed. Also, with a shift towards laptops and mobile computing devices, the popularity of external storage devices is only going to increase further. This is why we weren't at all surprised that the external storage category got amongst the most survey respondents.

Last year, we excluded pen drive manufacturers, but this year, with available capacities crossing the 100 GB mark, and prices falling, Pen drives are a popular alternative to bulkier external hard drives - especially if it's work, and not movies that are being transported / backed-up.

Overall, however, this category didn't change much in terms of the top brands. Seagate won the top honours, though Western Digital has closed the gap between first

and second place in your trust index. Although Seagate edged out Western Digital in almost every survey question, it was very interesting to note that more people believe their next purchase in this category will be a Western Digital product. At the risk of reading too much

Interesting Facts

- 53% people first think of Seagate when they think of external storage
- 37% own Seagate, and 29% own Western Digital products
- Both Seagate and WD score high on reliability (91% and 86% respectively)
- 70% of people feel their next purchase will be Western Digital



into this, we're very interested to see what the next year will hold in this category. A whopping 86 per cent of people felt it was likely that they'd be open to buying a WD device. Seagate wasn't far behind, with 83 per cent of people saying they'd look at Seagate's products when they buy next. That really is the story in this category, with mar-

gins of a mere 3 and 4 percent in every question separating these two giants of storage.

Transcend, Sandisk and Kingston (in that order) complete the top 5, and this, to us, is evidence of the growing importance of Flash in the external storage market overall. Of those three brands, more people said they were likely to look at buying a Transcend device when they make their next purchase (76.6 per cent). Sandisk followed with 68.5 per cent people saying the same for them. Sandisk did beat Transcend in the style category, with more people finding their products stylish and well designed.

In the question we don't score, more people said they see Kingston advertising than either Sandisk or Transcend. More people read reviews about Sandisk products than the other two. Apacer and Freecom did the worst, with over 80 per cent saying they are not exposed to their products at all.

